

ILLUSTRATIVE CULTURAL ACCESS REPORT

COMMON GROUND

Stories, spaces, communities.

An honest design exercise.

Common Ground is a self-directed editorial design concept. All statistics, interviews, organizations, community profiles, and findings in this publication are fictional and were created solely to demonstrate multi-page layout, typography, data visualization, information hierarchy, and print-production thinking. Concept imagery is illustrative.

PUBLICATION SYSTEM

FORMAT

8.5 x 11 in

LENGTH

28 pages

GRID

12 columns

BASELINE

14 pt

MARGINS

0.67 in

COLOR

CMYK concept

BINDING

Perfect-bound concept

EXPORT

Print PDF + web PDF

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Culture is what br

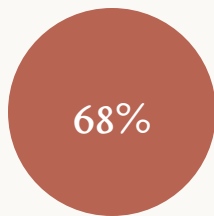
Public culture is not only a collection of institutions. It is the accumulated experience of invitations, routes, prices, signs, schedules, and shared rituals that make participation feel possible.

An illustrative editorial report about access, communication, and belonging.

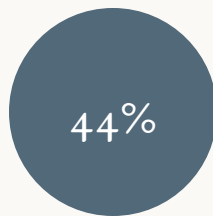


Participation begins before the door.

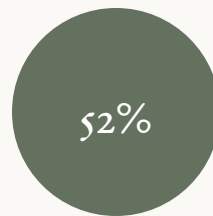
Five scenario findings organize the report. The figures below are illustrative data created for this design exercise.



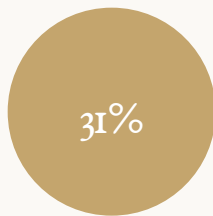
participated in a cultural activity



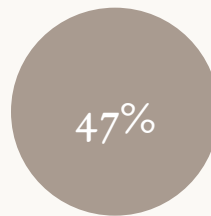
named cost as a barrier



valued neighborhood proximity



wanted clearer multilingual
information



were motivated by a friend
invitation

The 15-minute *culture gap*

Cultural participation is often described as a question of interest: people attend when a program feels relevant, and stay home when it does not. But the distance between curiosity and attendance is built from smaller decisions. Is the venue reachable after work? Is the price visible before checkout? Can someone understand what will happen without already knowing the language of the institution? The report treats access as a sequence rather than a single barrier.

A neighborhood event may be physically close and still feel unfamiliar. A major institution may offer free admission and remain difficult to navigate. For the illustrative scenarios in this publication, participation rises when practical information and social invitation appear together. People are more willing to try an unfamiliar program when they can picture the setting, understand the timing, and know who might be welcome.

“Access is not one door. It is the sequence of small signals that tell someone whether the experience is meant for them.”

EDITORIAL PULL QUOTE

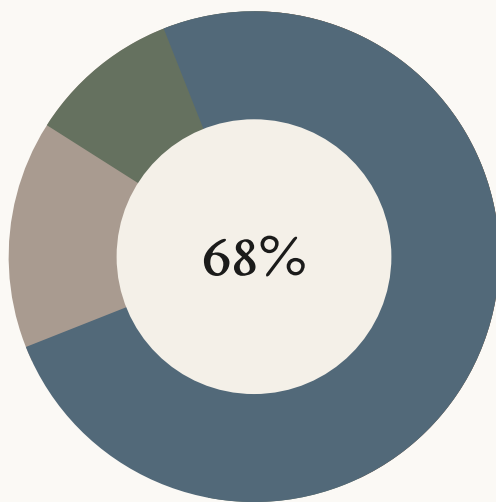


DESIGNING THE INVITATION

This suggests a design problem as much as a programming problem. Calendars, maps, ticket pages, posters, and social posts all shape the decision before a person reaches the door. Clearer communication cannot remove every structural barrier, but it can prevent avoidable uncertainty from becoming another reason to opt out.

Participation *by the numbers*

The report uses a restrained visual language so data feels integrated with the publication rather than dropped in from a dashboard.



- Participated
- Interested
- Unable
- Not seeking

KEY FIGURES

34%

attended an evening event

21%

created or practiced art

16%

volunteered with an organization

MOTIVATORS

What makes participation feel possible?



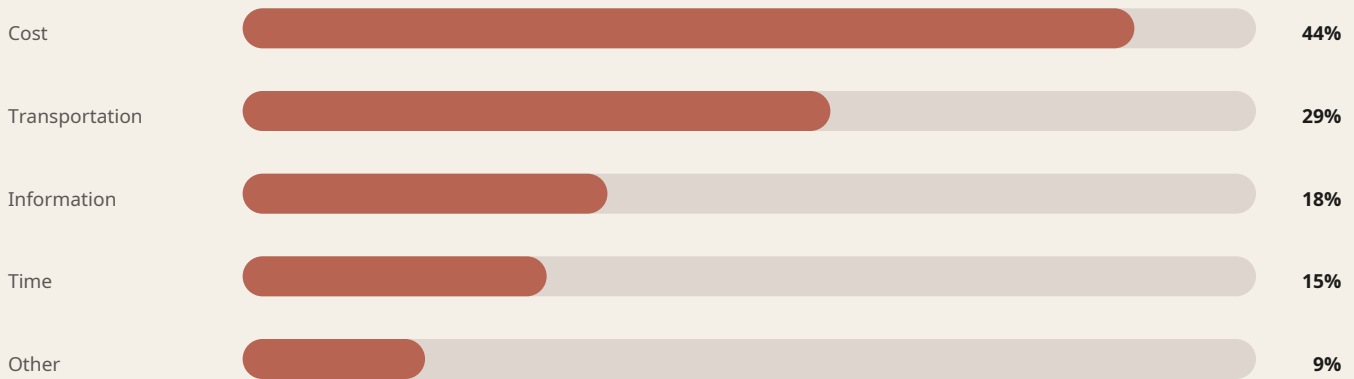
READING THE CHART

The bars are intentionally direct: labels remain outside the marks, values are written explicitly, and the scale is held consistent. This keeps the graphic usable in print, presentation, and social cutdowns.

Scenario data for editorial demonstration only. Multiple responses permitted.

05 / BARRIERS

What keeps *people away*



The barrier chart is framed as a communication prompt rather than a ranking of individuals. Each category points toward a different design or service response.



Design responses

O1

COST

Show full pricing, discounts, and free dates before checkout.

O2

TRANSPORTATION

Pair event information with route, arrival, and accessibility details.

O3

INFORMATION

Use plain language, photography, and multilingual summaries.

O4

TIME

Surface duration, start flexibility, and late-arrival expectations.

Spaces that *tell our story*





PHOTO ESSAY

Architecture, printed matter, and temporary graphics form one continuous visitor experience.



Three ways people describe belonging.

“I need to know what the room will feel like before I decide to go.”

FIRST-TIME VISITOR

“A friend’s message is often more persuasive than an advertisement.”

OCCASIONAL ATTENDEE

“I return when the staff, signage, and program all tell the same story.”

VOLUNTEER AND MAKER



EDITORIAL INTERVIEW FORMAT

West Side voices

A profile page can hold a portrait, a short narrative, a pull quote, and structured metadata without losing the rhythm of the larger publication.

08 / TIMELINE

A decade of *cultural change*

The timeline uses one shared axis, restrained annotation, and enough white space for scanning across a spread.



SCENARIO MILESTONES

TIMELINE DETAIL

Editorial rhythm across time.

A timeline can become unreadable when every event is treated as equally important. The system distinguishes primary milestones from supporting notes and keeps dates aligned to a stable baseline.

2014

RESIDENCIES

Longer-term neighborhood programs foreground local participation.

2020

OUTDOOR PIVOT

Programs move into plazas, sidewalks, and temporary structures.

2026

CO-DESIGN

Community review becomes part of concept development, not only evaluation.

Different places need different invitation

North

DENSE INSTITUTION NETWORK

Strong attendance, but complex calendars and competition for attention.

West

COMMUNITY-LED PROGRAMMING

Trust grows through recurring partnerships and local hosts.

South

LONG TRAVEL DISTANCES

Transportation and timing shape participation more than interest.

Central

HIGH VISITOR TRAFFIC

Wayfinding and multilingual information support first-time audiences.

ILLUSTRATIVE ORGANIZATION TABLE

Cultural organizations by area

AREA	ORGANIZATIONS	PROGRAMS	ILLUSTRATIVE ATTENDANCE
North	128	510	425,340
West	96	402	312,541
South	134	296	201,382
Central	78	356	187,654
Total	436	1,564	1,126,917

The table uses tabular numerals, a stable column rhythm, repeated row heights, and a strong total row so readers can compare without excessive ornament.

TABLE SYSTEM

Tabular figures

Consistent alignment

Alternating rows

Clear totals

What proximity changes

Proximity is not simply a distance measured on a map. It can describe how familiar a venue feels, how clearly an event is explained, whether a person sees their language in the invitation, and whether participation fits the shape of an ordinary day.

In the scenario data, neighborhood access and friend invitation appear alongside cost as major motivators. The combination matters. A nearby event still needs a clear message; an appealing program still needs a route, a schedule, and an entry point that feels understandable.

For designers, this shifts the assignment from promotion to orientation. The same communication system should help someone notice an event, evaluate it, arrive, and understand where to go next. Editorial hierarchy, digital UX, environmental graphics, and service information become parts of one continuous experience.





DESIGN IMPLICATIONS

One journey, *many touchpoints*

- **DISCOVER** Social posts, posters, calendars
- **EVALUATE** Pricing, duration, imagery, audience cues
- **ARRIVE** Route, entrance, accessibility, check-in
- **PARTICIPATE** Wayfinding, labels, staff communication
- **RETURN** Follow-up, membership, neighborhood trust

Design for the *whole invitation*

01 MAKE PRACTICAL DETAILS VISIBLE EARLY.

02 TREAT MULTILINGUAL INFORMATION AS CORE CONTENT.

03 DESIGN SOCIAL PROOF INTO THE INVITATION.

04 CONNECT DIGITAL ORIENTATION TO PHYSICAL WAYFINDING.

A COMMUNICATION FRAMEWORK

Notice □ Understand □ Arrive □ Belong

01

NOTICE

Reach someone with a clear visual and relevant context.

02

UNDERSTAND

Explain what happens, who it is for, and what it costs.

03

ARRIVE

Provide route, entry, accessibility, and wayfinding information.

04

BELONG

Use staff, labels, and follow-up to reinforce welcome.

How to read this publication

Illustrative data. The percentages, totals, profiles, milestones, and quotes are fictional scenario content created to demonstrate editorial and information design. They should not be cited as research findings.

Design intent. The publication explores a 12-column grid, 14-point baseline rhythm, running heads, folios, long-form text, pull quotes, charts, tables, timelines, and photo-led spreads.

Image use. Concept imagery was generated for this portfolio exercise and art-directed through crop, tone, and page composition.

Production intent. A final print edition would require licensed imagery, copyediting, accessibility review, color proofing, vendor consultation, and a verified data source.

EDITORIAL DELIVERABLES

28-page print report

Screen-optimized PDF

Executive-summary one-pager

Presentation adaptation

Social data cutdowns

Print production checklist

ENDNOTES

Notes on content and data

- I** All percentages and counts in this publication are illustrative and do not represent a real survey.
- 2** The terms North, West, South, and Central are used as fictional editorial groupings rather than official analytical regions.
- 3** The timeline combines fictional milestones with general trends solely to demonstrate chronology and annotation.
- 4** Quotes are written scenario content. No real interview participants are represented.
- 5** Any resemblance to an existing cultural organization, program, or report is coincidental.
- 6** Concept imagery should be replaced with commissioned or appropriately licensed photography in production.

COLOPHON

Publication system

ART DIRECTION & LAYOUT

Jocelyn Martinez

FORMAT

8.5 x 11 inches / 28 pages

GRID

12 columns / 14-point baseline

TYPOGRAPHY

EB Garamond + Noto Sans

PALETTE

Warm paper, charcoal, clay, olive, blue

PRODUCTION CONCEPT

CMYK / 0.125-inch bleed / perfect bound

DATA

Fictional scenario content

IMAGERY

Illustrative concept imagery

CLOSING

Building a better future together.

Good cultural communication does not promise that every barrier has disappeared. It shows respect for the questions people need answered, the routes they need follow, and the many ways belonging begins before arrival.



Stories. Spaces. Communities.



COMMON GROUND / ILLUSTRATIVE CULTURAL ACCESS REPORT

DESIGNED BY JOCELYN MARTINEZ / 2026